

Quod Tango Muto

A manuscript scaffold for later writing



Working premise

From the repo's source motto, *quod tango muto*: what I touch, I change. This manuscript is a four-part scaffold for motion, contact, and transformation.

Scaffold edition

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Opening position

Chapter prompt

Write the first true sentence of the book here. Name the tension, motion, or atmosphere that justifies the title *Quod Tango Muto*.

Use this opening chapter to establish what kind of book this is, what world it enters, and what kind of attention it asks from the reader.

1.1 Purpose

State the reason this manuscript exists.

1.2 Immediate questions

- What must the reader understand immediately?
- What mystery, claim, or pressure sets the book in motion?
- What is the emotional or intellectual temperature of the first pages?

Foundations

Chapter prompt

Define the concepts, assumptions, symbols, or conditions the rest of the manuscript depends on.

Use this chapter to stabilize the vocabulary and architecture of the book.

2.1 Terms

Define the central words and recurring ideas.

2.2 Scope

Clarify what belongs inside the book and what remains outside it.

Main development

Chapter prompt

Build the primary argument, narrative line, investigation, or sequence of transformations here.

This is the longest structural space in the starter manuscript. Expand it into subchapters later if needed.

3.1 Movement

Describe how the book advances from one idea or state to another.

3.2 Evidence

List the kinds of proof, scenes, references, examples, or formal structures the chapter should use.

Counterforce

Chapter prompt

Record the pressures that resist the book: objections, rival interpretations, ambiguities, or unresolved fractures.

Use this chapter to keep the manuscript intellectually honest.

4.1 Counterarguments

What intelligent disagreement should the book face directly?

4.2 Unresolved edges

What tensions should remain visible rather than being smoothed away too early?

Resolution

Chapter prompt

Write the final statement that survives the journey of the manuscript.
Keep it clear enough to guide revision later.

Use the closing chapter to show what has changed and what remains.

5.1 Last page test

If the reader remembers only one paragraph, what should it be?

Working notes

Use this appendix as a live workshop

Store chapter fragments, quotations, title variants, structural sketches, source trails, and alternate endings here until they find a better home in the manuscript.

- Quotes to revisit
- Sources to collect
- Chapter fragments
- Structural ideas
- Discarded passages worth preserving